



WHEN BENGALURU'S KEMPEGOWDA

International Airport opened in 2008, its ambition was modest—to

become the gateway to southern India for air travellers. Bangalore International Airport Ltd (BIAL) has raised that bar a few notches: it is now aspiring to become a global transit hub.

Bold bets on infrastructure, entailing as much as ₹20,000 crore capital expenditure, are part of a plan drawn up by BIAL to achieve the ambition, which Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer Hari

Marar says will ensure the airport stays in step with Bengaluru's own rapid growth.

"Aviation oils the engine of the economy," Marar tells *BT*.

Investment in capacity expansion is essential because, without it, Bengaluru's connectivity, especially important for IT and outsourcing industries, to which it is an important home, risks being impaired, he says.

Fairfax India Holdings Corp. (the parent company of majority private promoters) is playing a key role in the journey. Anchorage Infrastructure Investments Holdings Ltd owns 43.64% and FIH Mauritius Investments Ltd 30.36% of BIAL. Karnataka State In-

KEY FIGURES



Bengaluru Airport to handle 48 million passengers in 2025



Terminal 2 expansion to double international capacity to 20 million travellers



Expansion project cost is ₹16,000–20,000 crore, backed by AAA credit rating



BIAL developing offices, hotels, arena, convention centre, and MRO facilities



Bengaluru eyes global hub status with Air India, IndiGo partnerships